

evidence

HXC-040 — CLAUDE.md §9/§3.4 anti-bluff smoke command made trustworthy

Problem (reproduced)

Original literal command `grep -rn "simulated\\|for now\\|TODO implement\\|placeholder" helix_code/internal helix_code/cmd` returns 527 hits → prints “BLUFF FOUND” on a GENUINELY CLEAN codebase. Breakdown: 218 `_test.go` (mocks allowed, CONST-050), 123 `i18n tr (/ " *_placeholder"` keys; production term counts: `simulated=0`, `TODO implement=0`, `for now=3` (all comments documenting REMOVED bluffs), `placeholder=306` (all `i18n/template infra`). Zero real bluffs.

Latent bug found (bonus)

The ORIGINAL command was case-SENSITIVE → it would have MISSED the canonical BLUFF-001 marker `// For now, simulate generation (capital F) exactly as written` in CLAUDE.md §3.3.

Refined command (now in CLAUDE.md §3.4 + §9)

```
grep -rniE "nowTODO implement|in production this would"
helix_code/internal helix_code/cmd | grep -v "_test.go:"
| grep -vi 'tr(_placeholder"' | grep -viE ':[[:space:]]//"'
| grep -q . && echo "BLUFF FOUND" || echo "clean"
```

Proof

- Refined command on real tree → “clean” (0 hits)
- §1.1 mutation pair: planted 3 bluffs into `helix_code/cmd/cli/main.go` (BLUFF-001 comment + simulated-response string + TODO implement) → refined command reported “BLUFF FOUND” catching all three → reverted → “clean”, `main.go` md5 byte-identical to backup.
- The quoted-string plant caught proves the `//`-citation exclusion does not weaken real bluff detection.